

Thursday, 13 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Clear 37° 21°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 36° 20°	MANCHESTER Overcast 35° 22°	GLASGOW Light drizzle 24° 18°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The Prime Minister is urging the public to avoid using disposable barbecues during the current spell of extremely dry weather.

This comes as PM Burnham considers a ban on single-use grills to help prevent wildfires. The move highlights growing concerns about fire risks across the UK.

ENVIRONMENT · UK
- 2

The Prime Minister has admitted that current cost of living support isn't enough, hinting at further help for households.

Since taking office three weeks ago, the PM has announced various measures. However, the ongoing crisis means more assistance might be on the way.

ECONOMY · UK
- 3

Households living near upgraded electricity pylons could soon see £250 a year knocked off their energy bills.

The first sites eligible for this discount have been revealed. It applies to homes within 1,600 feet of new or upgraded pylons, aiming to compensate for local disruption.

ENERGY · UK
- 4

Four people have been found guilty over the horrific torture and death of a man who was set alight.

Tomasz Samel was kidnapped, subjected to extreme violence, doused in petrol, and then set on fire. The conviction brings some closure to a truly shocking case.

CRIME · UK
- 5

Children as young as nine are being hurt in a growing number of e-scooter crashes across the UK.

Three major trauma centres in Liverpool, Manchester, and Sheffield have treated nearly 500 casualties under the age of 16. This highlights serious safety concerns about e-scooter use.

SAFETY · UK

What's coming up

- 1** **Hollywood star Nicholas Hoult has joined the cast of the new Harry Potter TV series, playing Gilderoy Lockhart.**

Known for roles in X-Men and Superman, Hoult is the latest big name to sign up. Fans are eagerly anticipating this fresh adaptation of the beloved books.

| ON AIR – Who would you cast in other iconic Harry Potter roles?

TV · COMING UP
- 2** **Gavin & Stacey star Melanie Walters, who played Gwen, has been announced as the final celebrity for this year's Strictly Come Dancing line-up.**

She completes the 15-strong cast for the popular dance competition. Fans will be excited to see how she fares on the dancefloor.

| ON AIR – What's your favourite Strictly moment ever?

TV · COMING UP
- 3** **The UK's largest Harry Potter shop is set to open in London on November 4th, promising a magical experience for fans.**

Warner Bros says the flagship store will be inspired by the enchanting Diagon Alley. It's expected to be a major attraction for Potterheads.

| ON AIR – If you could visit any fictional shop, which one would it be?

RETAIL · AUTUMN
- 4** **The boy behind the global phenomenon 'Baby Shark' is now 17 and is set to make his K-pop debut.**

The catchy tune is the most-watched YouTube video of all time. He's hoping to transition from children's entertainer to K-pop sensation.

| ON AIR – What's a song you can't get out of your head, no matter how hard you try?

MUSIC · COMING UP
- 5** **Spotify is introducing a new feature to label AI-generated artists and remove them from recommendations, starting next month.**

From mid-September, listeners will be informed if an artist is AI-generated. This move aims to differentiate human and artificial creativity on the platform.

| ON AIR – Do you think AI-generated music will ever replace human artists?

MUSIC · AUTUMN

On the schedule

- 1** **England's new Test captain Joe Root has scrapped the midnight curfew imposed on the team by his predecessor Ben Stokes.**

The curfew had been in place for seven months, aiming to improve discipline. Root's decision signals a new era for the Test squad.

ON AIR – Do you think curfews help or hinder team performance?

CRICKET · UK
- 2** **England's Red Roses are gearing up for the WXV Global Series, training with controversial smaller rugby balls.**

The team is in pre-season training, preparing for the upcoming international competition. The use of smaller balls is a notable change in their preparations.

ON AIR – Do you think rule changes like smaller balls make sports more exciting or just confusing?

RUGBY · UK
- 3** **Netherlands' Nadine Visser dramatically won the 100m hurdles gold by just one thousandth of a second at the European Athletics Championships.**

Visser pipped Poland's Pia Skrzyszowska in a photo finish in Birmingham. It was an incredibly close race, showcasing the thrilling nature of top-level athletics.

ON AIR – What's the closest sporting finish you've ever witnessed?

ATHLETICS · UK
- 4** **Aston Villa are competing in the Super Cup for the first time since 1982, with manager Unai Emery chasing his first win in the competition.**

Emery has more recent experience of the match, but this is a rare appearance for Villa. Fans will be hoping for a historic victory.

ON AIR – How important are 'minor' trophies like the Super Cup to you as a fan?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 5** **The cult indoor football event, Tennent's Soccer Sixes, is returning later this year with all 12 Scottish Premiership clubs entering teams.**

It will be a legends version of the popular tournament, bringing back some famous faces. Fans will be excited to see their heroes back on the pitch.

ON AIR – Which former player from your favourite club would you most love to see play again?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A recent trend sees more people rediscovering the simple pleasure of 'window shopping' without buying anything.**
It's all about enjoying the displays and atmosphere, rather than the pressure to purchase, offering a mindful way to explore local high streets.
- 2 Experts suggest that the charming act of 'feeding garden birds' can significantly reduce stress and boost feelings of contentment.**
Connecting with nature, even in a small way, brings a quiet joy and a sense of contributing to the local ecosystem.
- 3 The delightful resurgence of 'traditional British fêtes and village fairs' is bringing communities closer together.**
With their classic games, local produce, and cheerful atmosphere, these events offer a wonderful taste of quintessential British summer.
- 4 A new appreciation for 'the art of mending clothes' is gaining popularity, particularly among younger generations.**
It's a sustainable way to extend the life of favourite garments and adds a unique, personalised touch to fashion.
- 5 Studies indicate that 'the simple act of reading a physical newspaper' can improve focus and information retention.**
Stepping away from screens for a bit of traditional news consumption offers a different, more tactile engagement with current affairs.
- 6 There's a charming new focus on 'local walking tours led by residents', offering unique insights into neighbourhoods.**
These informal tours reveal hidden histories and quirky facts that only a local would know, enriching the experience of exploring.
- 7 The delightful trend of 'swapping homemade jams and preserves' among friends and neighbours is fostering community spirit.**
It's a lovely way to share culinary creations and enjoy a taste of seasonal goodness from your local area.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to reach something just out of our grasp, even if it looks a bit silly?

ANSWER: STRETCHING OUR NECK OUT AS FAR AS IT CAN GO, AS IF THAT EXTRA INCH WILL MAGICALLY APPEAR!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, fresh slice of pizza. What is it?

ANSWER: CAREFULLY BLOTTING OFF ANY EXCESS OIL WITH A BIT OF KITCHEN ROLL.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you discover a 'clever little hack' that makes a household chore surprisingly easier or faster?

What's your go-to, tried-and-tested trick for tackling something around the house that you'd love to share with everyone?

- We all have those 'favourite local landmarks' that, even if they're not world-famous, hold a special place in our hearts.

What's a local monument, building, or natural feature in your area that you particularly love, and why is it so special to you?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** There is a planet made almost entirely of diamonds, called 55 Cancri e, located about 40 light-years away in the constellation Cancer.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Astronauts on the International Space Station can see the Great Wall of China with the naked eye from orbit.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£24 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£24 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The longest place name in the UK is Llanfairpwllgwyngyllgogerychwyrndrobwlantysiliogogoch, in Anglesey, Wales.
- Bumblebees can fly higher than Mount Everest, as they have been observed at altitudes of up to 9,000 metres.
- The inventor of the frisbee was turned into a frisbee after he died, as his ashes were moulded into commemorative discs.
- A group of owls is called a 'parliament', likely due to their wise and solemn appearance.
- The British Isles are home to over 6,000 miles of public footpaths, offering countless walking opportunities.
- The world's smallest mammal is the bumblebee bat, found in Thailand and Myanmar, weighing less than a penny.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- The 'dog days of summer' refers to the period between July 3rd and August 11th, named after the star Sirius, also known as the 'Dog Star'.

On this day

Day 225 of the year, 140 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Benedetto Sinigardi; Christian feast day: Benildus Romançon; Christian feast day: Cassian of Imola; Christian feast day: Clara Maass (Lutheran Church). Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1982 — Sebastian Stan, Romanian-American actor
- 1961 — Neil Mallender, English cricketer and umpire
- 1951 — Dan Fogelberg, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2007)
- 1974 — Joe Perry, English snooker player
- 1964 — Debi Mazar, American actress
- 1967 — Quinn Cummings, American actress, author, and entrepreneur
- 1944 — Kevin Tighe, American actor
- 1945 — Robin Jackman, Indian-English cricketer and sportscaster (died 2020)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1964 — Peter Allen and Gwynne Evans are hanged for the murder of John Alan West becoming the last people executed in the United Kingdom.
- 1940 — World War II: The German Luftwaffe launches an air operation, codenamed Adlertag, during the Battle of Britain in an attempt to destroy the British Royal Air Force.
- 1944 — World War II: German troops begin the pillage and razing of Anogeia in Crete that would continue until September 5.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1918 — Women enlist in the United States Marine Corps for the first time. Opha May Johnson is the first woman to enlist.
- 1920 — Polish–Soviet War: The Battle of Warsaw begins and will last till August 25. The Red Army is defeated.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1913 — First production in the UK of stainless steel by Harry Brearley.

1968 — Alexandros Panagoulis attempts to assassinate the Greek dictator Colonel Georgios Papadopoulos in Varkiza, Athens.

- 1942 — Major General Eugene Reybold of the U.S. Army Corps of Engineers authorizes the construction of facilities that would house the "Development of Substitute Materials" project, better known as the Manhattan Project.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 226 of the year, 139 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Arnold of Soissons; Christian feast day: Domingo Ibáñez de Erquicia; Christian feast day: Eusebius of Rome; Christian feast day: Fachtna of Rosscarbery. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1946 — Susan Saint James, American actress
- 1968 — Catherine Bell, English-American actress and producer
- 1959 — Marcia Gay Harden, American actress
- 1956 — Andy King, English footballer and manager (died 2015)
- 1965 — Paul Broadhurst, English golfer
- 1946 — Larry Graham, American soul/funk bass player and singer-songwriter
- 1983 — Elena Baltacha, Ukrainian-Scottish tennis player (died 2014)
- 1983 — Mila Kunis, Ukrainian-American actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1947 — Pakistan gains independence from the British Empire as the Dominion of Pakistan, due to the partition of India.
- 2006 — Lebanon War: A ceasefire takes effect three days after the United Nations Security Council's approval of United Nations Security Council Resolution 1701, formally ending hostilities between Lebanon and Israel.
- 2015 — The U.S. Embassy in Havana, Cuba re-opens after 54 years of being closed when Cuba–United States relations were broken off.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1967 — UK Marine Broadcasting Offences Act 1967 declares participation in offshore pirate radio illegal.
- 1947 — Pakistan gains independence from the British Empire as the Dominion of Pakistan, due to the partition of India.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

SAT 15 Premier League season begins (2026/27)

22–23 Belgian Grand Prix (F1)